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SOVON9
HR POLICY HANDBOOK

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Applies To: All employees of Sovon9

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1. INTRODUCTION

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Welcome to Sovon9.

This HR Policy Handbook establishes the general employment policies, workplace expectations, leave provisions, and HR procedures applicable to employees of Sovon9.

The purpose of this handbook is to provide employees with a clear understanding of company policies and workplace expectations and to ensure that HR processes are applied consistently and fairly.

This handbook should be read together with an employee's

appointment letter, employment agreement, and applicable statutory requirements.

Where an employee's appointment letter or applicable law provides a different requirement, the applicable document or law will prevail.

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2. WORKING HOURS

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Standard working hours at Sovon9 are:

Monday to Friday
9:30 AM to 6:30 PM

Employees are generally entitled to a one-hour lunch/meal break during the workday.

Employees are expected to be available and ready to work at the beginning of their scheduled working hours.

Certain teams or roles may have different working schedules based on business requirements.

Any change to an employee's regular working schedule should be approved by the reporting manager.

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3. ATTENDANCE AND PUNCTUALITY

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Regular attendance and punctuality are essential to maintaining an effective workplace.

Employees are expected to:

- Report to work on time.
- Maintain accurate attendance records where required.
- Inform their reporting manager as soon as possible if they are unable to attend work.
- Obtain approval before taking planned leave.
- Avoid repeated late attendance or unexplained absences.

Frequent unauthorized absence or habitual lateness may result in appropriate corrective or disciplinary action.

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4. LEAVE POLICY

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Sovon9 provides employees with the following annual leave entitlements:

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement
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Casual Leave (CL)	5 days
Sick Leave (SL)	5 days
Earned Leave (EL)	5 days

Total Annual Leave: 15 days

The leave year and eligibility may be subject to the employee's employment terms and applicable company procedures.

4.1 CASUAL LEAVE

Casual Leave may be used for personal matters, urgent family requirements, appointments, or other short-duration needs.

Employees should apply for Casual Leave in advance whenever reasonably possible.

4.2 SICK LEAVE

Sick Leave may be used when an employee is unwell or requires medical treatment.

Employees should notify their reporting manager at the earliest opportunity when they are unable to report to work because of illness.

For extended sickness or repeated medical absence, Sovon9 may request reasonable medical documentation.

4.3 EARNED LEAVE

Earned Leave is intended primarily for planned absences, vacations, personal commitments, or other longer-duration requirements.

Employees should submit Earned Leave requests sufficiently in advance to allow their manager to plan work and resources.

4.4 LEAVE APPLICATION PROCEDURE

All leave requests should be submitted through the OneHR app.

The general process is:

1. Employee submits the leave request through OneHR.
2. Reporting manager reviews the request.
3. Manager approves or rejects the request based on business requirements and available leave balance.
4. Approved leave is recorded in the employee's leave balance.

Employees should not assume that leave is approved until the

request has been formally approved.

4.5 EMERGENCY LEAVE

In emergencies where advance application is not possible, employees must inform their reporting manager or HR as soon as reasonably possible.

The employee should subsequently record the leave in OneHR.

4.6 LEAVE DURING NOTICE PERIOD

Leave during the notice period may be subject to management approval and applicable company policy.

Employees should discuss planned leave with HR and their reporting manager before submitting such requests.

5. LEAVE CARRY FORWARD AND ENCASHMENT

Unless otherwise communicated by HR or required under applicable law:

- Unused leave does not automatically carry forward to the following year.
- Leave encashment is not automatic.
- Any carry-forward or encashment arrangement will be communicated separately by the company.

Applicable statutory requirements will prevail where they provide employees with greater rights.

6. PUBLIC HOLIDAYS

Sovon9 will observe a holiday calendar issued by the company each year.

The holiday calendar may include national holidays and other holidays determined based on business requirements and applicable local regulations.

Employees working on designated holidays may be eligible for compensatory leave or other applicable benefits in accordance with company policy and applicable law.

7. SALARY AND PAYROLL

Salary is normally credited to employees on the 2nd day of every month for the preceding salary period.

If the scheduled salary date falls on a bank holiday, weekend, or circumstances outside the company's control, the actual credit date may vary.

Employees are responsible for ensuring that HR has accurate and up-to-date:

- Bank account details
- PAN/tax information
- Government identification details where required
- Contact information
- Other payroll-related documentation

Any changes to payroll information should be communicated to HR promptly.

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8. PROBATION AND CONFIRMATION

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New employees may be placed on a probationary period of six months, unless a different period is specified in their appointment letter.

During probation, the employee's:

- Performance
- Attendance
- Conduct
- Communication
- Job knowledge
- Ability to meet role expectations

may be reviewed.

Successful completion of probation may result in formal confirmation of employment.

The company may extend probation where additional time is reasonably required to assess performance.

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9. PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT

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Sovon9 encourages regular communication between employees and managers regarding performance and development.

Performance may be evaluated based on:

- Quality of work
- Productivity
- Timeliness
- Collaboration
- Initiative

- Communication
- Reliability
- Achievement of role-specific objectives

Performance reviews may be conducted periodically based on the company's business requirements.

10. WORK FROM HOME / REMOTE WORK

Remote or work-from-home arrangements may be permitted based on:

- Role requirements
- Business needs
- Employee performance
- Managerial approval

Working remotely does not change an employee's responsibility to maintain normal working hours, productivity, availability, confidentiality, and professional conduct.

Employees must ensure that they have a suitable and secure working environment when working remotely.

11. OVERTIME AND ADDITIONAL WORKING HOURS

Employees may occasionally be required to work beyond normal working hours due to business requirements.

Where overtime or additional working hours are formally required, employees should follow the applicable approval process.

Any overtime compensation or compensatory leave will be governed by company policy and applicable law.

Employees should not routinely work excessive hours without discussing workload concerns with their reporting manager.

12. CODE OF CONDUCT

All employees are expected to maintain professional and respectful behavior.

Employees must:

- Treat colleagues, customers, vendors, and visitors respectfully.
- Act honestly and ethically.
- Protect company information.
- Follow reasonable management instructions.

- Avoid conflicts of interest.
- Maintain professional communication.
- Use company resources responsibly.
- Comply with applicable laws and company policies.

The following may result in disciplinary action:

- Harassment or bullying
- Discrimination
- Threatening or abusive behavior
- Theft or fraud
- Falsification of company records
- Unauthorized disclosure of confidential information
- Serious misconduct
- Deliberate damage to company property
- Repeated violation of company policies

13. ANTI-HARASSMENT AND EQUAL OPPORTUNITY

Sovon9 is committed to maintaining a workplace where employees are treated with dignity and respect.

The company does not tolerate harassment, bullying, discrimination, intimidation, or retaliation.

Employees who experience or witness inappropriate workplace behavior should report the matter to HR or an appropriate management representative.

Complaints will be handled as confidentially as reasonably possible and investigated appropriately.

For matters covered by applicable Indian workplace laws, Sovon9 will follow the relevant statutory procedures.

14. CONFIDENTIALITY AND DATA PROTECTION

Employees may have access to confidential company information, including:

- Business plans
- Customer information
- Financial information
- Employee information
- Passwords and credentials
- Software and technical information
- Internal documents
- Proprietary processes

Employees must not disclose confidential information to unauthorized individuals during or after employment.

Company information should only be accessed, copied, stored, or shared for legitimate business purposes.

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15. INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY AND COMPANY ASSETS

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Company-provided laptops, phones, software accounts, email accounts, and other equipment are provided for authorized business purposes.

Employees are expected to:

- Protect company devices and credentials.
- Use strong passwords.
- Avoid sharing passwords.
- Report security incidents promptly.
- Avoid installing unauthorized software.
- Return company property when requested or upon separation.

Employees should not use company systems for unlawful, fraudulent, abusive, or inappropriate activities.

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16. PERSONAL DEVICES AND SECURITY

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Where employees use personal devices for work, they are responsible for maintaining reasonable security.

Employees should:

- Keep devices updated.
- Use screen locks and passwords.
- Avoid accessing sensitive information through unsecured networks.
- Immediately report suspected loss or unauthorized access involving company information.

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17. CONFLICT OF INTEREST

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Employees should avoid situations where personal interests conflict, or appear to conflict, with Sovon9's business interests.

Potential conflicts may include:

- Working for a competing organization without approval.
- Personal financial interests involving company vendors.
- Using company opportunities for personal benefit.
- Accepting inappropriate gifts or benefits from business partners.

Potential conflicts should be disclosed to management or HR.

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18. GIFTS AND BUSINESS COURTESIES

Employees should exercise good judgment when accepting gifts, discounts, entertainment, or other benefits from customers, vendors, or business partners.

Employees must not accept anything that could improperly influence a business decision or create an actual or perceived obligation.

19. EMPLOYEE COMMUNICATION

Employees are expected to maintain professional communication through:

- Email
- OneHR
- Company-approved messaging platforms
- Official meetings
- Other authorized communication channels

Important work-related decisions and approvals should be documented through appropriate company channels.

20. GRIEVANCE PROCEDURE

Employees who have workplace concerns are encouraged to raise them promptly.

The recommended process is:

1. Discuss the matter with the immediate reporting manager where appropriate.
2. If unresolved, approach HR.
3. HR may review the concern and speak with relevant parties.
4. Appropriate action will be taken based on the circumstances.

Employees will not be penalized for raising legitimate concerns in good faith.

21. DISCIPLINARY PROCEDURE

Depending on the seriousness and circumstances of a violation, Sovon9 may take appropriate corrective action, which may include:

- Verbal counseling
- Written warning
- Performance improvement measures
- Suspension where appropriate

- Termination of employment

The company will consider the nature of the violation, available evidence, previous conduct, and applicable law before taking disciplinary action.

Serious misconduct may result in immediate disciplinary action, subject to applicable legal requirements.

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22. RESIGNATION AND NOTICE PERIOD

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Employees wishing to resign should submit a formal resignation to their reporting manager and HR.

Unless a different period is specified in the employee's appointment letter, the standard notice period will be 30 days.

During the notice period, employees are expected to:

- Continue performing their duties professionally.
- Complete pending assignments.
- Document relevant processes.
- Support knowledge transfer.
- Return company property.
- Complete required exit formalities.

The company may approve an earlier release or notice-period adjustment where appropriate.

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23. FULL AND FINAL SETTLEMENT

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Upon separation, Sovon9 will complete applicable exit and payroll formalities.

The employee may be required to complete:

- Asset return
- Access termination
- Knowledge transfer
- Clearance procedures
- Documentation
- Exit interview, where applicable

Final settlement will be processed in accordance with company procedures and applicable law.

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24. EMPLOYMENT RECORDS

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Employees are responsible for keeping HR informed of changes to their:

- Residential address
- Telephone number
- Emergency contact
- Bank details
- Tax information
- Other relevant employment information

Providing inaccurate or outdated information may delay HR or payroll processes.

25. WORKPLACE HEALTH AND SAFETY

Sovon9 is committed to providing a reasonably safe and healthy working environment.

Employees should:

- Follow workplace safety instructions.
- Report hazards or unsafe conditions.
- Report workplace accidents promptly.
- Maintain cleanliness in shared areas.
- Follow emergency procedures.

Employees should cooperate with safety initiatives and emergency drills where applicable.

26. PROFESSIONAL APPEARANCE

Employees are expected to maintain a clean, professional, and workplace-appropriate appearance suitable for their role and interactions with customers, partners, and colleagues.

Specific dress requirements may apply to certain roles or business occasions.

27. SOCIAL MEDIA

Employees are free to maintain personal social media accounts, provided that their activities do not:

- Disclose confidential company information.
- Misrepresent the company.
- Harass or threaten colleagues.
- Violate applicable laws.
- Improperly use Sovon9's intellectual property or branding.

Employees should make clear when expressing personal opinions that they are speaking personally rather than on behalf of Sovon9, unless authorized to represent the company.

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28. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

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Work products, documents, designs, software, processes, inventions, materials, and other intellectual property created by employees in the course of their employment may belong to Sovon9 to the extent provided by applicable law and the employee's employment agreement.

Employees must protect company intellectual property and must not use it for unauthorized personal or third-party purposes.

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29. POLICY CHANGES

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Sovon9 reserves the right to amend, update, replace, or withdraw policies when necessary due to:

- Business requirements
- Organizational changes
- Changes in applicable law
- Operational requirements
- Employee feedback

Employees will be informed of significant policy changes through appropriate company communication channels.

Where applicable law provides a different or more favorable statutory entitlement, the applicable law will prevail.

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Effective Date: 1 September 2026

This handbook is intended as a general internal HR policy document for employee reference. Company-specific legal, statutory, payroll, leave, and employment requirements should be reviewed by appropriate HR/legal professionals before formal adoption.

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